

Title MD Moldova ruling party tax and age retirement alleged increase

27/10/2025

Summary

- On 18th of September, PAS2025[.]eu, a [website](#) mimicking PAS2025.md official website, published news about Party of Action and Solidarity (PAS) that stated in its election manifesto that it would raise the retirement age and income tax, introduce conscription for women, and extend the length of military service.
- In the following days several X accounts spread the news and a fake video leveraging misleading narratives distracting from the real PAS program.
- Between September 18 and 20 at least 14 X accounts reached several hundred thousand views, few hundreds of retweets and likes.
- The incident aimed to defame the PAS party ahead of the parliament election.
- Recommendations include social media platforms to take action regarding coordinated amplification of disinformation.

Incident

On 18th of September PAS2025[.]eu published news about the PAS party that stated in its election manifesto that it would raise the retirement age and income tax, introduce conscription for women, and extend the length of military service. These false claims originated from a fake website designed to mimic the official PAS page. PAS2025[.]eu [website](#) and a [video](#) circulated as if these were official campaign materials. The fabricated website is nearly identical to the official PAS website. While both websites list “5 PAS commitments for the next 4 years,” the official site makes no mention of tax, retirement age or military service changes. The commitments listed on the official website include doubling the incomes of the working population, doubling the sales of goods and services from Moldova abroad, and promoting national culture. The [Gnida Project](#), an anonymously run group of volunteers that tracks Russian influence operations, said in an X [post](#) on September 18, 2025, that the false narrative appears to be the work of Storm-1516, a Russian influence operation that is reported to be an offshoot of the Internet Research Agency, the notorious Russian troll farm. The most viewed posts on X were from [@IvankaNews](#), [@Truthtellerftm](#), [@wolsned](#), and [@DangerousThinkg](#). Accounts republished in coordinated way fabricated content on PAS campaign material from [PAS2025.eu](#) website

Systemic Violation Assessment

This incident poses a direct risk to Moldova’s electoral and democratic process. By spreading fabricated claims that the ruling PAS party intends to raise taxes, increase the retirement age, extend military service, and draft women into the army, the disinformation aims to erode public trust in the party ahead of the September 28, 2025 parliamentary elections. Such narratives can mislead voters, polarize public opinion, and distort democratic decision-making. Given the geopolitical context, they also risk undermining Moldova’s pro-EU trajectory and amplifying Russian influence in the country’s internal affairs.

The manipulation lies both in the falsified content and in the tactics used. The incident involves outright disinformation: a fake website and fabricated video imitating official PAS campaign materials, falsely attributing controversial policy pledges to the party. The narrative was then amplified across social media through misleading posts and videos. The manipulative tactics used were

- Impersonation: A fake website (PAS2025.eu) closely mirrored the official PAS site (PAS2025.md) to deceive users.
- Fabricated media: A campaign video was created to look like official party material.
- Coordinated amplification: Pro-Kremlin accounts spread the content widely on X, using anonymous or inauthentic profiles to boost reach.
- Deceptive design: The fake website was made visually identical to the real PAS website, exploiting voter confusion

Moldova has legal frameworks that regulate electoral campaigning and prohibit the dissemination of false information and impersonation during elections. Creating counterfeit campaign material, misusing a party’s name, and spreading fabricated claims to influence voters could be prosecuted under laws related to fraud, defamation, or election interference. The impersonation of a political party’s official website and the distribution of fabricated videos would likely be considered unlawful acts under Moldovan electoral and cybercrime legislation. The Digital

Service Act (DSA) Infringement Category Disinformation and Manipulated Media.

Infringement:

- Harmful Influence Operations targeting Electoral Integrity. DSA article(s): "34" Observable(s) matched: "Failure to curb inauthentic pages or profiles posing as official sources and distributing misleading information (e.g. fake election commission accounts announcing bogus results)."
- Evidence excerpt / location: "The false narrative is based on a fake website pas2025.eu imitating the PAS official website, and a video posing as official campaign material and a network of X accounts amplifying website content." PAS2025.eu, the website used to advance the false claim, is not an official PAS website

Narrative

Meta-narrative 1: Moldovan ruling party imposing new legislation hurting its citizens and women.

Sub-Narrative 1-1: Moldovan government is failing its citizens by imposing new taxes and burdens on the young generation.

Impact

Reach: Brief traffic spike in a few days referring to deceptive website, now [closed](#), X accounts having a reach of more than 280,000 views, 727 reposts, and 2,642 likes. The largest X accounts involved were @TruthTellerftm, @wolsned and @DangerousThinkg.

Outcome: The website is not available anymore.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective 1: [T0140.001: Defame](#): Inauthentic content published to misrepresent PAS program

[T0097.206: Government Institution Persona](#): Website impersonating PAS party, posting inauthentic content.

[T0049.007: Inauthentic Sites Amplify News and Narratives](#): Fake website copies PAS website spreading false video and content.

[T0049.001: Trolls Amplify and Manipulate](#): Several X accounts posting and spreading false content and video from pas2025[.]eu deceptive website

Recommendations and Actions Taken

Actions Taken: N/A.

Recommendations:

- Social media platforms should address the incident on the grounds of coordinated disinformation amplification;
- Registrar and hosting provider needs to take down the inauthentic website.

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	FIMI Assessment
N/A	Russia.	Upon Request	Andrea Nicolai, DEN Institute	Website, X.	Medium Certainty